After it was over, a servicewoman who was a German refugee demanded to know why I had not stood up.

I said, "It's not the National Anthem. I don't have to stand up."

Whereupon she delivered herself of a strong denunciation of me for my lack of patriotism.

When she was all through, I said, "You don't demonstrate your patriotism by singing a bad song. If you think that's patriotism, it shows you don't know anything about it." 3

Since I had clear logic on my side, there was nobody against me but the damn fools. Unfortunately, that category included almost everyone in the room.

On April 25, by the way, my role as bridge fiend came to a permanent end. Bridge games had continued ever since our train trip, and in one game that day I bid a grand slam that I felt absolutely confident of making, since between myself and the dummy, I owned virtually every trump. Nevertheless, through a piece of elementary miscalculation, I found myself set three. After that, I still played an occasional bridge hand, but only occasionally, and always unenthusiastically. That mishandled grand slam poisoned the game for me.

For a while, I shifted to chess. What happened was that I read Stefan Zweig's The Royal Game (in my opinion the best story about chess ever written) and tried to drum up a game and couldn't. So I

3 I would have liked to have asked her if her father had ever sung "Deutschland iiber Alles" and, if so, what that proved, but I was quite certain that she would then assault me and I managed to keep it down, thank goodness.

tried strategy. I gave The Royal Game to Ed James and said, "Would you like to read a good story?"

An hour later he came to me and said, "Would you like to play a game of chess?"

We played quite a few games, but, as usual, I was steadily beaten and my ardor finally cooled.

In participating in the round of pleasures, I remained prudent, of course, and